

Assessment Brief: Digital Systems Design (COSC2407)

Course code COSC2407

Course title Digital Systems Design

Assessment name Case Analysis and Design Proposal Report

Assessment type Individual, written report

Weighting 40% of the final course grade

Word count 1,800 words (see Section 4 -- this is a requirement)

Due date Friday 23 October 2026, 23:59 (RMIT Vietnam local time)

Submission point Canvas > COSC2407 > Assignments > Case Analysis Report

Version 1.0 -- this document is the authoritative requirement

1. How this assessment is described in the course guide

This assessment asks you to analyse a documented service case and to propose a conceptual design in response to it. It is a written analysis assessment. You are assessed on the quality of your analysis, the traceability of your claims to the case pack and to the course literature, and the clarity of your written argument.

This document states what is assessed and what you must submit. It does not tell you how to produce any part of the report. The teaching team will not read an outline before submission, and no draft is assessed.

2. Task description

You are engaged as a consultant by a mid-sized Australian university. The university has published a student wellbeing check-in service that asks enrolled students to record how they are coping. The service was released to all students at the start of the teaching period. Six weeks later the university has received three complaints, has seen use fall away, and does not know whether the service is working as intended.

The case pack in Canvas > Course Resources > Case Pack contains: the published service description; the consent notice that students see; three de-identified complaint records; and one set of fortnightly usage figures. Nothing in the case pack is a requirement of this assessment. The case pack is the material you analyse.

Your task is to produce one written report that (a) states the problem the service was intended to address and what the available evidence shows about whether it does, (b) sets out the stakeholders and the needs that the evidence supports, (c) proposes a conceptual response and justifies it against the evidence and the course literature, and (d) identifies the risks and ethical considerations that a university would have to weigh before acting on your proposal.

Part B of the report is the part that requires you to explain your own design decisions. The explanation in Part B must be your own reasoning, expressed in your own words, and it must be traceable to the evidence you cite. Your tutor will read Part B closely.

3. Required sections and deliverables

Submit one PDF containing the following sections, in this order.

- Part A -- Problem statement: the purpose of the service and what the evidence shows.
- Part B -- Design rationale: a conceptual response and the reasoning behind each design decision you make.

- Part C -- Stakeholder and needs analysis: who is affected, what each group needs, and how you know.
- Part D -- Risks and ethical considerations: at least three, each with the evidence or source that raises it.
- Part E -- Conclusion: what you would advise the university to do next and what would change your advice.
- A reference list in RMIT Harvard style.
- An appendix of no more than two pages containing evidence you reference but do not reproduce in the body.

4. Word count -- how the limit is applied

The report body is 1,800 words. This is a stated requirement of the assessment and not a suggestion or a target. A submitted report whose body is outside 1,620 words to 1,980 words receives a penalty under criterion 5 of the marking rubric, which is worth 10% of the assessment.

The following are excluded from the 1,800-word count: the title page; table of contents and figure and table captions; the in-text citations themselves; the reference list; the appendix; and the declaration of AI use required by Section 7. Everything else in Parts A to E, including headings, counts toward the limit.

Student Services does not accept a word count that was not verified. You must state the body word count of the report on the title page, and it must be the word count produced by the word processor used to write the report.

5. Format and submission requirements

- One PDF. The submission portal does not accept any other format.
- A4 pages, 2.5 cm margins, a legible 11 or 12 point body font, 1.5 line spacing.
- A title page carrying the course code, assessment name, your student number, your tutor name, the declared body word count, and the date of submission.
- Page numbers on every page after the title page.
- The declaration of AI use from Section 7, completed and signed, immediately after the reference list.
- Submitted through Canvas by the due date above. A submission is late from one minute past the due time.

6. Assessment and feedback

The assessment is marked out of 100 against the marking rubric published with this brief. The rubric names five criteria and their weights, and describes what separates a pass from a distinction on each. Read the rubric before you begin; the rubric is the statement of what is rewarded.

Marks and feedback are returned through Canvas within fifteen working days of the due date. A rubric-based breakdown of your mark is attached to each return.

A request for an extension must be lodged through the RMIT extension and special consideration process before the due date. Teaching staff do not grant extensions by email and do not discuss an assessment after the due date except through that process.

7. AI use is governed by this assignment's own policy

This assignment has its own AI Usage Policy. It is a separate document, published beside this brief in Canvas, and it forms part of the requirements of this assessment. The policy states the uses of generative AI that are permitted for this assessment and the uses that are prohibited, and it names the one prohibition that has no exceptions.

Read the policy before you start work and again before you submit. Work that does not meet the policy is treated as an academic integrity matter under the RMIT Academic Integrity Policy, and it is dealt with under that policy rather than under this brief.

8. Academic integrity

All submitted work must be your own. Where you use the work, the words, or the ideas of another person, you must acknowledge it in RMIT Harvard style, whether the source is a published document, a teaching staff member, a fellow student, or a generative AI tool.

Contract cheating is prohibited. Presenting work that another person produced, including work produced by a generative AI tool at your direction and submitted as your own, is a breach of the Academic Integrity Policy and is reported.

The teaching team may ask you to discuss your submission, or the reasoning behind any part of it, at any time after the due date. Being unable to explain your own design decisions in Part B is treated as evidence that the work is not yours.

9. Questions about this assessment

Questions about the requirements, the rubric or the AI Usage Policy may be raised in the Canvas discussion board for this assessment or privately with your tutor. Answers that change the requirement are published as an announcement and, where the change is material, as a new version of this brief.